



EXTERNAL STORAGE

With the barriers between our professional and personal lives blurring, the need of the day is something that will let you transport your data efficiently and reliably between computers. At one time, all we had were the trusty CD-R and Zip drives. But today, there is a vast variety of external storage devices tailor-made for our many requirements such as the storage capacity, speed and most importantly, adaptability with the wallet. As a result, we have portable CD-Writers based on the USB 2.0 standard for fast write speeds and even portable hard disk drives that can withstand physical shock and rough treatment.

Choosing your backpack

The ideal external storage device for you is largely dependent on your applications. There are three basic kinds of portable storage solutions available today—portable CD-RW drives, portable hard disks and Zip drives. Each of these are characterised by different performance levels, capacity, compatibility and cost.

The performance characteristics you need to consider are the read and write data transfer speeds between the drive and your host computer for different file types. Also consider the latency and the access time when transferring and reading data. External CD-RW drives are known for the low cost and universal compatibility of their media and are therefore most suited to home users and applications that involve file sizes under 700 MB. Zip drives are suited only to applications where the installed base of the drives among users is large enough to warrant you to buy one. Since they are not known for their speed and have storage

Nominees

Name	Contacts	Comments
Iomega HDD 20 GB	JIngram Micro India Pvt Ltd, Ph: 022-25202901	This sleek 20 GB portable has provided quick access times transfers, making it highly suited to transporting large multimedia files.
Freecom FHD-1 60 GB HDD	J.S Equipments, Ph: 022-23810713	Boasting of a 60 GB size, this disk sports a USB 2.0 interface suited to transferring large amounts of data between computers.

capacities comparable to CD-RW drives, they are not situations that require transfer of large volumes of data.

The most suitable performance devices for external storage are the external hard disk drives. They offer high-speed transfer and plenty of storage capacity. Also, since they use around high-speed interfaces such as USB 2.0, data transfer from these devices is faster than any other external device. The USB 2.0 standard connects them to any computer that has a USB port, though you would see the maximum transfer rates only when used on USB 2.0 compliant computers. The only downside is that they are expensive.

And the award goes to...

The external storage device that gets kudos for its performance this year is the Freecom FHD-1 20 GB external hard disk drive. It is based on the USB 2.0 standard and delivered data transfer rates of 17 MBps when transferring data sequentially. With blistering performance in both read and write tests across a variety of file types, this drive is ideally suited for applications that required gigabytes of data to be transferred between locations.



Freecom FHD-1 20 GB
J.S. Equipments,
Ph: 022-23810713

The verdict: With USB 2.0 functionality, this drive provides the fastest method to get large amounts of data ported from computer to computer

VIDEO EDITING

Adobe Premiere 6.0

Adobe Premiere brings with it a host of added functionality and a very powerful set of features for working with digital video. It includes FireWire support through which you can hook up a DV cam to your computer and transfer high-quality video for processing in NTSC or PAL format. Many parameters such as the frame size and rate, compression ratio, colour depth, audio, etc can be configured.

There is also support for the widescreen (16:9) format. A DV editing mode enables the program to send captured and rendered digital video through the FireWire port to an external device directly

for full-quality previewing. You can create video for the Internet in a variety of optimised formats such as QuickTime and RealMedia. Premiere 6.0 also contains a complete 99-track Audio Mixer for professional-level audio mixing.



Adobe Premiere 6.0
Adobe Systems India Pvt Ltd,
Ph: 914532026

The verdict: With a host of features like FireWire support for DV capture, export to web-based video format, added effects and robust audio mixing port, this a brilliant digital video editing tool for professionals

